

1865

MAY

With most Confederate forces having surrendered, President Andrew Johnson issues a general amnesty to all "rebels," other than senior Confederate officers and officials.



Swearing oath of loyalty

JUNE

President Johnson appoints governors for six former Confederate states and restores Tennessee to the Union.

NOVEMBER

Mississippi enacts laws to establish the first "Black Codes." These deal with labor law, vagrancy, and similar issues, and are designed to restrict the rights of those who had been enslaved.

DECEMBER

The Thirteenth Amendment to the U.S. Constitution, abolishing slavery, comes into effect, having been ratified by 27 states.